Assignment – 03

Hotel Booking Command Center — Page Elements Use Case

1. Objective

To design and build a single internal "Command Center" Page in Zoho Creator for the existing "Hotel Room Booking" application, demonstrating the correct usage of all eleven Page Builder elements — Panel, Board, Chart, Gauge, Search, Form, Report, Snippets, Button, Widgets, and Viewer — so that the hotel's front office and management have one unified workspace to monitor, manage, and act on booking data.

2. Problem Statement

The hotel's front office currently checks booking status through the default form report, but this gives no quick visual sense of tonight's occupancy rate, no easy way to search for a specific guest's booking during a busy check-in rush, no drag-and-drop way to move bookings through processing stages, and no single place to view a guest's ID proof document. Staff waste time switching between the report, the housekeeping register, and shared folders just to serve a single guest.

Design a single internal Page in Zoho Creator that acts as the front office's command center for hotel operations, combining live data, quick actions, and reference material, using every Page Builder element Zoho Creator provides, so that staff can monitor and manage the entire booking lifecycle from one screen.

3. Scope of the Use Case

- Application Name: Hotel Room Booking & Front Office Management
- Page Name: Hotel_Command_Center_Page
- Primary Users: Hotel Front Office Staff, Manager, Housekeeping Supervisor
- Underlying Form/Report: Room_Booking_Form, Room_Booking_Report, RoomType_Popularity_Chart
- Objective of the Page: Provide a single internal workspace that combines monitoring, searching, processing, and reference material for hotel bookings

4. Page Elements Used and Their Mapping

The table below maps every Page Builder element available in Zoho Creator to its role on the Hotel_Command_Center_Page.

Page Element	Element Name	Purpose	Placement on Page
Panel	Command_Center_Main_Panel	Acts as the primary structural container that groups all other elements into one cohesive dashboard	Wraps the entire page as the outer layout container

Page Element	Element Name	Purpose	Placement on Page
Board	Booking_Status_Board	Provides a Kanban-style board so front-office staff can drag bookings between processing stages	Central column: columns for Enquiry, Confirmed, Checked-In, Checked-Out
Chart	RoomType_Popularity_Chart_Widget	Visualizes live booking counts per room type as a bar chart	Top-right area, next to the Gauge
Gauge	Occupancy_Rate_Gauge	Displays tonight's occupancy rate as a circular gauge (e.g., 45 of 60 rooms occupied)	Top-left area, first element the duty manager sees on opening the page
Search	Guest_Search_Bar	Lets staff instantly look up a specific guest's booking by name, phone number, or booking ID	Fixed at the top of the page, above the Board
Form	Quick_Walkin_Booking_Form	Embeds the Room_Booking_Form for front-office staff to register walk-in guests directly from the command center	Right-hand panel, accessible via a tab or expandable section
Report	Full_Bookings_Report	Embeds the complete Room_Booking_Report for detailed row-level review and export	Lower section of the page, below the Board
Snippets	Hotel_Policy_Snippet	Reuses a pre-built content snippet (check-in/check-out policy and cancellation terms) that is shared across the booking form, this page, and confirmation emails	Sidebar, as quick-reference text for staff handling guest queries
Button	Send_Checkin_Reminder_Button	Provides a one-click action button to trigger check-in reminder emails to guests arriving today	Placed directly above the Booking Status Board, near the Confirmed column
Widgets	Housekeeping_And_Arrivals_Widgets	Displays a small gallery of supporting widgets — live housekeeping status and today's arrivals/departures list — for staff coordination	Bottom strip of the page, below the Full Bookings Report

Page Element	Element Name	Purpose	Placement on Page
Viewer	Guest_ID_Document_Viewer	Embeds an inline document viewer so staff can open and reference a guest's uploaded ID proof without leaving the page	Sidebar, below the Hotel Policy Snippet

5. Page Layout (Section-wise)

Section 1 — Overview Strip

- Occupancy Rate Gauge (Gauge element)
- RoomType Popularity Chart Widget (Chart element)
- Guest Search Bar (Search element)

Section 2 — Processing Workspace

- Send Check-in Reminder Button (Button element)
- Booking Status Board (Board element)

Section 3 — Detailed Data

- Full Bookings Report (Report element)

Section 4 — Reference & Quick Actions (Sidebar)

- Hotel Policy Snippet (Snippets element)
- Guest ID Document Viewer (Viewer element)
- Quick Walk-in Booking Form (Form element, expandable tab)

Section 5 — Operations Strip

- Housekeeping and Arrivals/Departures Widgets (Widgets element)

All sections above are laid out within the Command_Center_Main_Panel, which serves as the single structural Panel wrapping the full page.

6. Configuration & Access Rules

- Panel (Command_Center_Main_Panel): configured with role-based visibility so only front-office and manager accounts can access the page.
- Board (Booking_Status_Board): each column mapped to a value of the Status field; dragging a card between columns updates the underlying record instantly.
- Chart (RoomType_Popularity_Chart_Widget): set to auto-refresh at a fixed interval so the manager always sees current room demand without manually reloading.

- Gauge (Occupancy_Rate_Gauge): total room inventory configurable; gauge color changes (e.g., green to red) as occupancy approaches full capacity.
- Search (Guest_Search_Bar): configured to search across Guest Name, Contact Number, and Booking ID fields simultaneously.
- Form (Quick_Walkin_Booking_Form): identical validation rules to the standard Room_Booking_Form, ensuring data consistency regardless of entry point.
- Report (Full_Bookings_Report): includes export-to-Excel capability restricted to manager-level accounts only.
- Snippets (Hotel_Policy_Snippet): centrally managed so that any edit to check-in/check-out or cancellation policy automatically reflects wherever the snippet is reused.
- Button (Send_Checkin_Reminder_Button): triggers a workflow that emails only guests whose Check-In Date is today, to avoid sending reminders to future bookings.
- Widgets (Housekeeping_And_Arrivals_Widgets): housekeeping status refreshes in real time as rooms are marked ready; arrivals/departures widget pulls from today's confirmed bookings.
- Viewer (Guest_ID_Document_Viewer): configured to display the latest uploaded ID proof document without requiring a manual link update each time a new file is uploaded.

7. Workflow Summary

- Step 1: A front-office staff member opens the Hotel_Command_Center_Page and immediately sees the Occupancy Rate Gauge and RoomType Popularity Chart for a quick status check.
- Step 2: If they need to find a specific guest, they use the Guest Search Bar rather than scrolling through the full report.
- Step 3: As guests check in and out, staff drag booking cards across the Booking Status Board to reflect the current stage.
- Step 4: For guests arriving today, staff click the Send Check-in Reminder Button to trigger bulk reminder emails.
- Step 5: For a walk-in guest, staff use the Quick Walk-in Booking Form directly from the command center instead of navigating to a separate page.
- Step 6: For deeper analysis or export, the manager scrolls to the Full Bookings Report.
- Step 7: When a guest asks about hotel policy or a room's readiness, staff refer to the Hotel Policy Snippet, check the Housekeeping Widget, and open the Guest ID Document Viewer for uploaded identification.

8. Expected Learning Outcomes

- Understand the purpose and correct use case for each Page Builder element in Zoho Creator.
- Learn how to combine Forms and Reports with visual monitoring elements (Chart, Gauge, Board) into a single operational dashboard.
- Practice using Search to make large guest datasets quickly navigable for front-office staff.
- Understand how Snippets support content reuse and consistency across multiple pages and forms.
- Learn how Widgets and Viewer elements extend a page with supporting media and reference documents.

9. Deliverable for This Lab Exercise

Students must build the Hotel_Command_Center_Page in Zoho Creator's Page Builder exactly as specified above, using all eleven Page elements, and submit a screenshot-based lab record showing: (a) the full page in the Page Builder editor with all elements labeled, (b) the Gauge and Chart elements reflecting live sample data, (c) a drag-and-drop interaction on the Board element demonstrated with before/after screenshots, and (d) the Viewer element successfully displaying a sample guest ID document.